

DEEP TIME · DOCUMENTATION

Pollen at sixty metres.

A water bore went 480 metres down. What came up on the way is still being read.

We drilled at Lancewood Ridge — the oldest land type on the property — looking for water. Four hundred and eighty metres down before we hit it.

We asked the drillers to keep a soil sample every six metres on the way.

That's eighty samples, from a hole we were paying to make anyway. The cost of asking for them was close to nothing.

Pollen buried in sediment layers is one of the main ways scientists reconstruct what a landscape looked like before anyone was there to write it down — what grew, when the climate shifted, how the ground changed underneath it. In a region where age itself is hard to pin down, a pollen record from underground is sometimes the only clock available.

Sixty metres down, there was pollen.

The samples went to QUT.

They're still being read.

This isn't a research programme we built from scratch. It's a habit: don't let a hole in the ground go to waste. Every bore is a core sample nobody else will ever get the chance to take — the ground only gets disturbed once.

You're paying to make the hole either way. The ground you bring up is a record nobody else has.

The depth is known. The interval is known.

What the pollen actually says about this Country's past is still being worked out — and when it is, this page gets rewritten, not written over.

Field record held with Queensland University of Technology (QUT). 480m depth, 6m sample interval, pollen confirmed at 60m. Analysis ongoing.